

Chapter 188 - Part 1

Extra 10-1

"Did she really kneel and kowtow up three thousand steps?" A somewhat weathered male voice sounded outside the hospital room.

A female voice that had cried until hoarse, carrying a nasal tone, answered: "Mm."

The man paused, waiting a few seconds: "Disgraceful."

"What do you mean by that?" The woman looked up, her face somewhat pale. She'd cried for too long, her eyes were red. "She's already lying in a hospital bed, can't you say something nice?"

"What nice things?" The man frowned and snorted coldly: "I said it long ago, her dating was wrong from the start."

"Uncle." Zhao Ying's cold voice sounded from the side, "Please say less."

Her words were still respectful, but also carried a bit of impatience.

Zhao's father had always doted on his niece Zhao Ying, precisely because Zhao Ying was much better at handling things than Zhao Xuning. She was always attentive with greetings and concerns, making everyone comfortable.

Not like Zhao Xuning, who aside from being smart was worthless in everything else.

So at this time, Zhao Ying's words were still effective.

Zhao's father frowned, wanting to say something, but in the end said nothing.

Zhao Ying stood to the side comforting Zhao's mother, "Auntie, you don't need to worry. Ning Ning is a doctor, she definitely knows what she's doing. When has she ever done anything to harm herself since childhood?"

Zhao's mother felt stifled, saying with a sob: "But she's so stubborn."

Zhao Ying: "..."

Zhao Ying was also afraid that the more she consoled, the more upset Zhao's mother would become, so she simply shut her mouth.

The hospital corridor was quiet. The best thing about VIP wards was this.

Inside the room, Zhao Xuning also lay quietly in bed, her forehead wrapped in thick layers of gauze, lying there without energy, eyes closed and motionless.

Still trapped in unconsciousness.

Zhao Ying did know some things about Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui.

Zhao Xuning's personality was too awkward; she didn't have many friends. Sometimes when she drank too much and felt stifled, she'd call Zhao Ying, so later Zhao Ying would occasionally tease Zhao Xuning about Shen Hui.

Zhao Ying thought Zhao Xuning would be able to let go.

Because since childhood, whatever Zhao Xuning wanted, she almost always got.

Otherwise, she would simply and decisively let go.

She'd never seen Zhao Xuning waver over anything.

If Zhao Ying and Zhao Ling went shopping together, they might have decision paralysis picking this and that, but Zhao Xuning wouldn't have this problem.

Zhao Xuning would definitely pick out what she wanted very efficiently, then go pay.

The word "hesitation" simply didn't appear in Zhao Xuning's life dictionary.

But she happened to meet Shen Hui.

Zhao Ying even calculated in her mind the probability of Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui getting back together, leaning more toward the two going their separate ways.

Because Zhao Xuning was too proud, too proud to bow her head.

And who was Shen Hui?

How could she possibly compromise for Zhao Xuning again and again?

But Zhao Ying never expected that one day, Zhao Xuning would kneel and kowtow up three thousand steps, not knowing whether it was to beg Shen Hui's forgiveness or to get back together with her.

When she saw her name trending on hot search and watched that video on the trending topic, Zhao Ying rubbed her eyes several times and had her assistant confirm it for her.

That really was Zhao Xuning.

It was that Zhao Xuning who was proud beyond measure.

When Zhao Ying rushed to the hospital, Zhao Xuning was still in the ward, and the doctor had given her fever-reducing injections.

But Zhao's parents still knew nothing about it. They blamed Zhao Xuning for disgracing the Zhao family, blamed Zhao Xuning for being useless—how could she throw away even her dignity for a woman?!

Listening to this, Zhao Ying felt terrible inside.

Although she didn't know why Zhao Xuning would do such a thing, Zhao Ying still protected Zhao Xuning.

Inside the ward, Zhao Xuning remained trapped in unconsciousness.

Calling it unconsciousness wasn't quite right—it was more like a gentle dream.

Heaven and earth became a huge, gentle cocoon, and she was wrapped inside it, which made her feel joyful.

Before long, she saw Shen Hui.

It was Shen Hui from their university days, appearing before her wearing a beautiful dress. Whenever she saw her, the corners of Shen Hui's eyes would lift, the arc of her mouth would curve upward. Back then, when Shen Hui smiled, her eyes sparkled brightly, looking as if she'd put the moon in her eyes.

Shen Hui always loved to call her: "Hey, Zhao Xuning."

When acting cute, she'd shake her arm and call: "Ning Ning wife, Ning Ning baby."

If she happened to bump or knock into something one day, she'd definitely call out aggrieved: "Wife~ it hurts."

Her voice milky and soft.

Clearly that wasn't her natural voice tone, but when those words came from her mouth, they were particularly pleasant to hear, making one feel particularly indulged.

Just thinking of past scenes made Zhao Xuning feel delighted.

That was happiness accumulated day by day.

If this was a dream, then Zhao Xuning wished to never wake from this long dream.

Zhao Xuning thought, her Ah Hui should be forever happy.

Forever maintaining that girlish state.

But she had destroyed such a Shen Hui.

So later, whenever Shen Hui saw her, she always had a cold face, her eyes always turning red.

Those insurmountable obstacles between them were like a walled city, trapping people in two separate worlds.

But would Shen Hui really be happy leaving her?

Would the people she met really be better than her?

Zhao Xuning's state of mind changed, and along with it, the dreamscape changed.

Slanting wind and cold rain, clouds of frost and fog and snow.

All quite unpleasant.

Later, in a patch of white mist, Shen Hui stood at the edge of a cliff, smiling as she waved at her, as if saying goodbye.

Then her body tilted backward and fell. Zhao Xuning's eyes widened as she ran forward, but caught nothing—only emptiness.

Zhao Xuning suddenly opened her eyes.

What met her gaze was blinding white, surrounded by the familiar smell of disinfectant. The pain from her forehead helped her distinguish dream from reality.

Even so, her back was covered in cold sweat.